



Samsung TVs with Assistant

Samsung's TVs from 2019 are speculated to be incorporating their in-house voice assistant, Bixby, as well as Google Assistant. <https://digit.in/jan19-13>



Sabotager Google

A former intern at Microsoft claims that Google launched code in YouTube to try and sabotage Microsoft Edge. <https://digit.in/jan19-14>

you grow past 3-4 team members. You pay a premium for flexibility then.” However, the one-time payment system saves a lot of time.

Another alluring factor is the availability of flexible space options. You can easily increase the number of team members overnight and have them incorporated in the coworking space the very next morning, and convenience.

Amenities

When a company leases private office space to work at, it often comes with the tedious burden of having to set up all the related infrastructure, along with its maintenance. All these worries are thrown right out of the window in a coworking space. All the administrative and operational tasks will be taken off the hands of the startup, while they can zero-in on growing their company.

Chaitanya Kumar, the Marketing Manager at 91springboard, Mumbai gave us a comprehensive list of all the amenities included at their coworking space which included 24x7 access with professional security, unlimited high-speed Wi-Fi and a lot more.

Networking

Coworking spaces give startups a chance to network and interact. Additionally, new startup members that are constantly surrounded by entrepreneurs and other startups are more likely to learn the ropes of the trade quickly. Chaitanya Kumar at 91springboard believes, “Aside from space itself, a coworking space provides access to a community of like-minded people. Here they will also have the opportu-

nity to find clients, partners, mentors, investors and friends.” 91springboard and a few other coworking spaces have sessions with mentors, which 91springboard calls ‘Mentor Hours’. These are free one-on-one sessions with an experienced entrepreneur, functional expert or a financial expert for about 40 minutes with the members of a coworking space.

Coworking spaces also provide greater access to key players and partnerships to help the startup businesses to grow to new heights. It is fairly obvious that a single space hosting a bunch of startups is likely to attract the attention of angel investors as well as venture capitalists looking for fresh opportunities. Networking events are also a fairly common perk at coworking spaces. Numerous coworking spaces act as incubators for the startups and are able to connect them with corporate partnerships.

DISADVANTAGES

Distractions

“The social environment of a coworking space can be a nuisance and your neighbours may not be as civil as you”, says Kumar from 91springboard. Distractions are aplenty at coworking spaces. This is primarily because you cannot always guarantee that your co-inhabitants at the coworking space will be in the same state of mind as you. Also, the availability of games, unlimited internet and even consoles in these spaces don't help to keep work strictly professional as is often required for startups to flourish, especially with younger employees..

Lack of Customisation

While the atmosphere and environment at coworking spaces are often aesthetically pleasing, they do not allow even the slightest bit of customisation for startups. This could probably hurt their brand image when meeting important clients. Ankit, the manager at Dunzo housed at Trios Pune, says, “The disadvantages of a coworking space would definitely be that we cannot tweak office layouts and we cannot boast the company brand on the interiors.”

Privacy concerns

Startups that have ideas of a good calibre usually experience some form of competition. In a coworking space, you may be subject to prying eyes, often from companies in the same field as you. Ajit Karape, the Finance Manager at 18th Parallel who works at Trios Pune, however, hasn't faced any such concerns yet. But they have only



Prying eyes could be a nuisance at coworking spaces.



Startups are able to connect with a wide range of like-minded people and also key members of their business.



You cannot possibly tell a 'loud' employee to keep it down at coworking spaces.

been stationed at Trios for a month. Maulik Bengali from Ajackus said, “Certainly, cannot deny that (privacy concerns). You are being easy to monitor. Whether its competition or not and how much that matters depends on the nature of the business.”

According to a recent report by Cushman and Wakefield, as of April 2018, flexible workspaces are occupying more than 8.1 million square feet of space across the eight major cities in India. The numbers validate their popularity, however, not all startups are suited to this kind of work environment. The above listed factors can help a startup make the right decision. 